So how do you get all this installed? It depends on your choice of development environment. We'll go over three common choices: Windows, macOS, and Ubuntu Linux. For the Linux option, we'll show setup for using a virtual machine running Linux, so this is the version you want if you want complete isolation of your Rails development environment.

But before you dive in, recognize that for best results these instructions are meant for a fairly fresh, up-to-date, and clean machine. If this doesn't match you, consider doing your development in a Docker container[8] or with Vagrant.[9] If either of these options appeals to you, proceed with the Linux instructions that will follow.

A special note for Windows users: most Rails applications are developed on MacOS machines and deployed to Linux machines. Some tools you may want to use, like passenger and redis, don't work natively on Windows.

This puts Windows developers at a disadvantage, as much of the helpful advice you can find online won't be geared toward you. Fortunately Microsoft provides three tools that will provide you with an absolutely first-class developer environment:

- Windows Subsystem for Linux (WSL)[10]
- Windows Terminal[11]
- Visual Studio Code[12]

With WSL2, select the latest Ubuntu version and proceed with the Linux instructions that follow.